

Japan Technology: IT Services: Accenture results read-across: Orders soften amid geopolitical headwinds; AI business expands

IT services major Accenture (Buy, covered by US Telecom/IT Services analyst James Schneider) announced 3Q8/26 (March-May) results at 20:00 JST (07:00 US local time) on June 18, followed by a conference call at 21:00 JST. 3Q sales were mostly in line with consensus, but 3Q orders turned down amid effects from the Middle East situation, and the company noted the potential for the negative impact from the Middle East could worsen in 4Q compared with 3Q. Based on its progress to date and other factors, management made slight revisions to its full-year sales guidance, lowering the upper end and midpoint of its forecast range. Although the situation is driven by impacts stemming from geopolitics rather than AI disruption, it could prolong weak investor sentiment toward system integrators. At the same time, corporate appetite for AI investment is robust, and AI-related business is expanding, centered on support for AI implementation, consulting on AI-led business transformation, data infrastructure, and security. In terms of read-across for the Japanese IT Services sector, based on our industry research, while the Middle East situation has had a limited impact on IT services demand in Japan, we see this as a slight headwind for NTT (Buy), given its subsidiary NTT Data's high overseas revenue exposure (60% overseas sales ratio in FY3/26). Meanwhile, Japan is starting to see a similar trend in terms of expansion in AI-related business, and we see Nomura Research Institute (Buy) and Trend Micro (Neutral) as well-placed to benefit. Below, we outline our key takeaways from the call (growth rates are all on a local-currency, or LC, basis).

- **3Q8/26 earnings:** 3Q8/26 sales of US\$18.72 bn (+3% yoy; 2Q growth was +4% yoy) landed at the midpoint of the guidance range (+1% to +5% yoy) and in line with the Bloomberg consensus (US\$18.76 bn). By region, sales growth was +1% yoy in the Americas (2Q: +3% yoy), +4% in EMEA (+2%), and +8% in Asia (+10%; [Exhibit 1](#)). The Americas was challenged from an ongoing impact of restrained investment by the US government (-2 pp), while growth improved in EMEA, mainly driven by the UK and Italy, and growth in Asia was led by Japan, Australia, and Singapore. By client industry, communications, media, and technology (+9% yoy) was strong, while demand was sluggish in healthcare & public services (flat yoy), mainly centered on US government business. Operating profits came in at US\$3.17 bn (+6% yoy), the operating margin rose +0.1 pp yoy ([Exhibit 2](#)), headcount increased +1.6% qoq, and the attrition rate was 14% (-2 pp yoy/+1 pp qoq; [Exhibit 3](#)).
- **Orders environment:** Turning to orders, 3Q new bookings swung to negative

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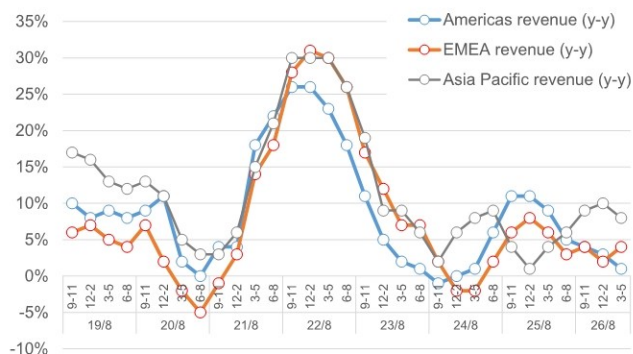
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growth for the first time in four quarters at -3% yoy (LC basis; 2Q: +1% yoy; [Exhibit 4](#)). By service type, consulting orders, a leading indicator for system integration and development demand, accelerated to +13% yoy (vs. +8% in 2Q; USD basis, no disclosure on LC basis), but managed services turned negative at -15% yoy (vs. +3% in 2Q). The number of clients with bookings of over US\$100 mn was flat at 30 (versus 30 in 2Q). Amid impacts from the Middle East situation, decision-making by some clients was delayed, resulting in negative impacts of c.US\$100 mn in sales and c.US\$400 mn in orders, primarily in consulting. The impact was particularly severe in the manufacturing and automotive industries, and Accenture noted the potential for this impact to rise further in 4Q. Client-specific factors also led to large managed service projects being pushed back to FY8/27 (delayed rather than lost). Meanwhile, corporate appetite for AI investment remains robust, as the focus shifts from proof of concept (PoC) to commercial deployment, fueling demand for AI implementation support and AI-driven business transformation consulting.

- **Guidance:** FY8/26 sales guidance (LC) was lowered to +3% to +4% yoy (from +3% to +5% yoy), or to +4% to +5% yoy (from +4% to +6% yoy) excluding US government business (which is expected to have a -1 pp impact on growth). This downward revision to both the upper end and midpoint of the range leaves the new midpoint below the Bloomberg consensus. By quarter, 4Q sales guidance (LC) calls for +1% to +5% yoy growth (+2% to +6% yoy excluding US government business). Management noted that negative effects from the Middle East situation could be greater than in 3Q.

Exhibit 1: North America slows, Europe accelerates, and Asia remains solid

Accenture sales growth by region (local-currency basis)

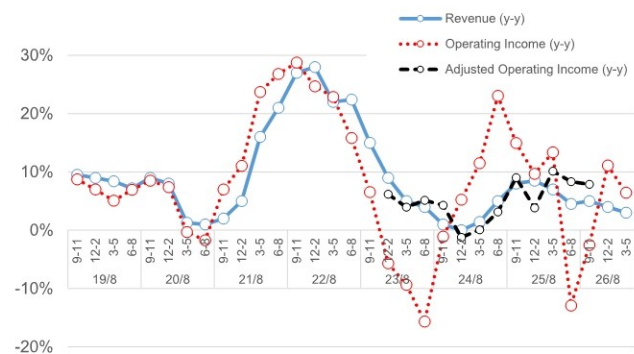


Regional definitions changed in 1Q8/24, reclassifying Latin America sales from Growth to North America, and with this North America was changed to Americas, while Growth was changed to Asia Pacific; EMEA unchanged.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Both sales and profit growth rates slow slightly

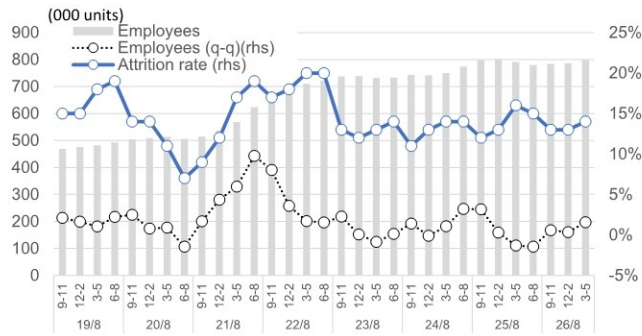
Accenture sales growth (LC basis) and operating profits/adjusted operating profits



Adjusted operating profits = operating profits + business optimization costs.

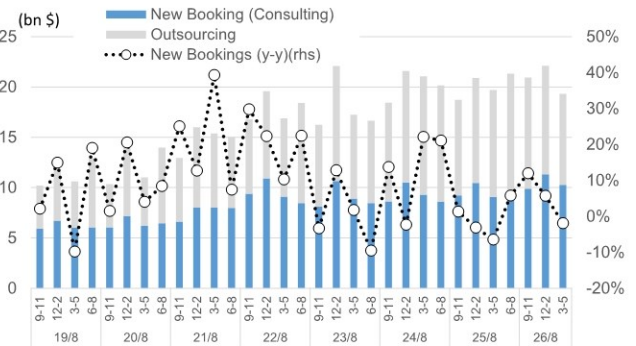
Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Headcount rises slightly qoq
Accenture headcount and attrition rate



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: 3Q order growth turns negative at -3% yoy
Accenture orders (USD basis)



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: 3Q8/26 sales mostly in line with consensus, but negative order growth of -3% yoy missed consensus

Accenture: Earnings statement

Accenture (ACN)(mn \$)	24/8				25/8				26/8			
	9-11	12-2	3-5	6-8	9-11	12-2	3-5	6-8	9-11	12-2	3-5	
New Bookings	18,450	21,580	21,060	20,150	18,700	20,910	19,700	21,310	20,940	22,110	19,320	
(y-y)	13.7%	-2.3%	22.1%	21.1%	1.4%	-3.1%	-6.5%	5.8%	12.0%	5.7%	-1.9%	
(y-y: LC)	12.0%	-2.0%	26.0%	24.0%	1.0%	0.0%	-7.0%	3.0%	10.0%	1.0%	-3.0%	
(BB ratio)	1.14	1.37	1.28	1.23	1.06	1.26	1.11	1.21	1.10	1.20	1.00	
Consulting	8,620	10,520	9,280	8,590	9,220	10,470	9,080	8,870	9,880	11,330	10,260	
(y-y)	6.3%	-1.2%	3.9%	1.4%	7.0%	-0.5%	-2.2%	3.3%	7.2%	8.2%	13.0%	
(BB ratio)	1.02	1.31	1.10	1.04	1.02	1.26	1.01	1.01	1.05	1.28	1.10	
Managed Services	9,830	11,060	11,780	11,550	9,480	10,440	10,620	12,440	11,060	10,780	9,060	
(y-y)	21.2%	-3.2%	41.6%	41.4%	-3.6%	-5.6%	-9.8%	7.7%	16.7%	3.3%	-14.7%	
(BB ratio)	1.27	1.42	1.47	1.42	1.10	1.25	1.22	1.41	1.19	1.17	0.96	
P/L												
Revenues	16,224	15,800	16,467	16,406	17,690	16,659	17,728	17,596	18,742	18,044	18,718	
(y-y)	3.0%	-0.1%	-0.6%	2.6%	9.0%	5.4%	7.7%	7.3%	6.0%	8.3%	5.6%	
(y-y: LC)	1.0%	0.0%	1.4%	5.0%	8.0%	8.5%	7.0%	4.5%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	
Operating Income	2,565	2,046	2,631	2,354	2,948	2,245	2,983	2,050	2,874	2,494	3,175	
(y-y)	-1.1%	5.2%	11.5%	23.0%	15.0%	9.7%	13.4%	-12.9%	-2.5%	11.1%	6.5%	
(OPM)	15.8%	13.0%	16.0%	14.3%	16.7%	13.5%	16.8%	11.6%	15.3%	13.8%	17.0%	
Business Optimization Cost (SGA)	140	115	77	106				615	308			
Americas	50	12	-4	25				420	67			
EMEA	71	86	75	17				132	170			
Asia Pacific	19	18	6	64				63	71			
Adjusted Operating Income	2,705	2,162	2,708	2,460	2,948	2,245	2,983	2,665	3,181	2,494	3,175	
(y-y)	4.3%	-1.2%	0.1%	3.1%	9.0%	3.8%	10.1%	8.4%	7.9%	11.1%	6.4%	
(OPM)	16.7%	13.7%	16.4%	15.0%	16.7%	13.5%	16.8%	15.1%	17.0%	13.8%	17.0%	
Revenues & Operating Income by Geographic Markets												
<Revenues>												
Americas	8,027	7,816	8,287	8,423	8,733	8,553	8,966	8,804	9,080	8,896	9,138	
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	8.8%	9.4%	8.2%	4.5%	4.0%	4.0%	1.9%	
(y-y: LC)	-	-	-	-	11.0%	11.0%	9.0%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	1.0%	
(% of sales)	49.5%	49.5%	50.3%	51.3%	49.4%	51.3%	50.6%	50.0%	48.4%	49.3%	48.8%	
EMEA	5,804	5,599	5,777	5,639	6,412	5,804	6,232	6,196	6,935	6,569	6,873	
(y-y)	9.2%	0.8%	-1.6%	1.5%	10.5%	3.7%	7.9%	9.9%	8.2%	13.2%	10.3%	
(y-y: LC)	2.0%	-2.0%	2.0%	6.0%	8.0%	6.0%	3.0%	4.0%	2.0%	4.0%	4.0%	
(% of sales)	35.8%	35.4%	35.1%	34.4%	36.2%	34.8%	35.2%	35.2%	37.0%	36.4%	36.7%	
Asia Pacific	2,394	2,385	2,404	2,344	2,544	2,302	2,530	2,596	2,727	2,578	2,707	
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	6.3%	-3.5%	5.2%	10.7%	7.2%	12.0%	7.0%	
(y-y: LC)	-	-	-	-	4.0%	1.0%	4.0%	6.0%	9.0%	10.0%	8.0%	
(% of sales)	14.8%	15.1%	14.6%	14.3%	14.4%	13.8%	14.3%	14.8%	14.6%	14.3%	14.5%	
<Operating Income>												
Americas	1,293	1,083	1,408	1,296	1,377	1,240	1,720	987	1,527	1,393	1,708	
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	6.5%	14.5%	22.2%	-23.8%	10.9%	12.3%	-0.7%	
(OPM)	16.1%	13.9%	17.0%	15.4%	15.8%	14.5%	19.2%	11.2%	16.8%	15.7%	18.7%	
EMEA	824	529	750	701	1,036	639	753	663	900	677	994	
(y-y)	13.3%	-14.0%	11.9%	48.9%	25.8%	20.8%	0.4%	-5.5%	-13.1%	5.9%	32.0%	
(OPM)	14.2%	9.4%	13.0%	12.4%	16.2%	11.0%	12.1%	10.7%	13.0%	10.3%	14.5%	
Asia Pacific	448	434	473	357	535	365	510	400	446	424	473	
(y-y)	-	-	-	-	19.4%	-15.9%	7.8%	12.1%	-16.7%	16.1%	-7.2%	
(OPM)	18.7%	18.2%	19.7%	15.2%	21.0%	15.9%	20.2%	15.4%	16.4%	16.4%	17.5%	
Revenues by Industry Groups												
Comm. Media & Tech	2,669	2,654	2,763	2,751	2,858	2,730	2,912	2,954	3,102	3,091	3,218	
(y-y)	-10.4%	-8.0%	-4.1%	1.6%	7.1%	2.8%	5.4%	7.4%	8.5%	13.2%	10.5%	
(y-y: LC)	-11.0%	-7.0%	-1.0%	5.0%	7.0%	6.0%	5.0%	5.0%	8.0%	10.0%	9.0%	
(% of sales)	16.5%	16.8%	16.8%	16.8%	16.2%	16.4%	16.4%	16.8%	16.6%	17.1%	17.2%	
Financial Services	3,034	2,809	2,895	2,873	3,169	3,010	3,279	3,316	3,602	3,395	3,489	
(y-y)	2.4%	-6.5%	-7.8%	-5.1%	4.5%	7.2%	13.3%	15.4%	13.7%	12.8%	6.4%	
(y-y: LC)	0.0%	-6.0%	-5.0%	-2.0%	4.0%	11.0%	13.0%	12.0%	12.0%	7.0%	3.0%	
(% of sales)	18.7%	17.8%	17.6%	17.5%	17.9%	18.1%	18.5%	18.8%	19.2%	18.8%	18.6%	
Health & Public Service	3,377	3,334	3,515	3,614	3,813	3,609	3,778	3,564	3,797	3,670	3,845	
(y-y)	12.6%	10.3%	7.6%	10.5%	12.9%	8.2%	7.5%	-1.4%	-0.4%	1.7%	1.8%	
(y-y: LC)	12.0%	10.0%	9.0%	11.0%	12.0%	10.0%	7.0%	-3.0%	-1.0%	-1.0%	0.0%	
(% of sales)	20.8%	21.1%	21.3%	22.0%	21.6%	21.7%	21.3%	20.3%	20.3%	20.3%	20.5%	
Products	4,860	4,762	4,983	4,949	5,425	5,052	5,344	5,376	5,741	5,477	5,669	
(y-y)	8.5%	0.9%	0.3%	4.2%	11.6%	6.1%	7.2%	8.6%	5.8%	8.4%	6.1%	
(y-y: LC)	1.0%	0.0%	2.0%	6.0%	10.0%	9.0%	7.0%	5.0%	4.0%	3.0%	3.0%	
(% of sales)	30.0%	30.1%	30.3%	30.2%	30.7%	30.3%	30.1%	30.6%	30.6%	30.4%	30.3%	
Resources	2,284	2,241	2,310	2,220	2,425	2,258	2,415	2,387	2,499	2,411	2,498	
(y-y)	6.8%	2.6%	-0.1%	-0.4%	6.2%	0.8%	4.5%	7.5%	3.1%	6.8%	3.4%	
(y-y: LC)	6.0%	4.0%	3.0%	3.0%	6.0%	5.0%	4.0%	5.0%	2.0%	2.0%	1.0%	
(% of sales)	14.1%	14.2%	14.0%	13.5%	13.7%	13.6%	13.6%	13.6%	13.3%	13.4%	13.3%	
Revenues by Type of Work												
Consulting	8,457	8,021	8,457	8,260	9,045	8,282	9,007	8,772	9,415	8,860	9,328	
(y-y)	0.1%	-3.1%	-2.7%	0.8%	7.0%	3.3%	6.5%	6.2%	4.1%	7.0%	3.6%	
(y-y: LC)	-2.0%	-3.0%	-1.0%	3.0%	6.0%	6.0%	6.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	1.0%	
(% of sales)	52.1%	50.8%	51.4%	50.4%	51.1%	49.7%	50.8%	49.9%	50.2%	49.1%	49.8%	
Managed Services	7,768	7,778	8,010	8,145	8,644	8,377	8,721	8,824	9,328	9,184	9,390	
(y-y)	6.4%	3.2%	1.8%	4.6%	11.3%	7.7%	8.9%	8.3%	7.9%	9.6%	7.7%	
(y-y: LC)	5.0%	3.0%	4.0%	7.0%	11.0%	11.0%	9.0%	6.0%	7.0%	5.0%	5.0%	
(% of sales)	47.9%	49.2%	48.6%	49.6%	48.9%	50.3%	49.2%	50.1%	49.8%	50.9%	50.2%	

LC denotes local currency basis; regional definitions changed in 1Q8/25, reclassifying Latin America sales from Growth to North America, and with this North America was changed to Americas, while Growth was changed to Asia Pacific; EMEA unchanged.

Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

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Rating and pricing information

Accenture Plc (Buy, \$156.01), NTT (Buy, ¥148), Nomura Research Institute (Buy, ¥4,655) and Trend Micro Inc. (Neutral, ¥5,909)

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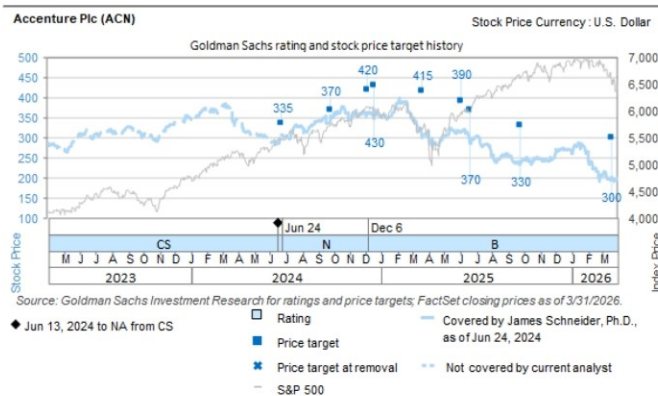
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Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	60%	45%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

Accenture Plc (ACN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
18-Jun-26	230.00	156.01
03-Jun-26	270.00	177.43
19-Mar-26	300.00	203.55
25-Sep-25	330.00	232.56
20-Jun-25	370.00	285.37
03-Jun-25	390.00	312.90
20-Mar-25	415.00	300.91
19-Dec-24	430.00	372.16
06-Dec-24	420.00	362.70
26-Sep-24	370.00	355.81
24-Jun-24	335.00	307.21

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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